London

Metropolitan Grand Lodge

Mentor's Guide to ENGAGE Support

1. INTRODUCTION

From their first meeting, the new Freemason/Companion is presented with a huge amount of information. They will want to make sense of this and learn at their own pace and in their own way about the organisation they have joined. While a lot of written and video material is available to them, it is important that they can be guided through it by a Personal Mentor who understands their interests and both their priorities and those of their Lodge/Chapter.

The Mentor's Engagement with the new member in the Craft/Royal Arch is particularly important because the new member needs to appreciate at an early stage that the organization is built on traditions, values, and a sense of brotherhood. Likewise, welcoming the new member in a meaningful and structured way ensures they will feel valued, informed and connected to the lodge/chapter.

The following paragraphs provide a brief outline of the things that a Personal Mentor can do to Engage a new member. A more detailed approach can be found in the Personal Mentoring Guide and Personal Mentoring Plan which are available on Rosetta and Metmentor.com.

1. MAKE THEM FEEL WELCOME

- Ensure that the new member is greeted warmly at their Initiation/exaltation ceremony by all the Lodge/Chapter members present. The new member will feel more at ease if everyone is friendly and welcoming.
- Congratulate the new member on their decision to become a mason/companion. Try to stress why you believe that they have made the right decision.
- Formally introduce them to all the Lodge/Chapter members present at the meeting and briefly outline the role of any Officers that they meet.
- After the Initiation/Exaltation ceremony, provide them with a Welcome Pack which should include:
    - The Words to the Opening & Closing Odes if sung
    - Essential Information about the Lodge/Chapter
    - The Lodge/Chapter History
    - Forthcoming activities and dates for their diary
    - Initiates' /Exaltee's guide if not presented at the meeting

2. ASSIGN THEM A PERSONAL MENTOR

- Assign a personal mentor to assist the new member with understanding Masonic/Royal Arch principles, rituals, and traditions.
- Encourage regular meetings with the mentor to review key lessons and provide personal support.

4. EXPLAIN THE LODGE/CHAPTER STRUCTURE, MASONIC CONDUCT and ETIQUETTE

- Explain the roles of the Lodge/Chapter Officers and the hierarchy within the lodge/chapter.
- Explain how meetings are conducted, how votes and ballots are held and when and why they may be asked to leave the Lodge/Chapter for a short while.
- Discuss how they are expected to participate in Lodge/Chapter activities and how they should conduct themselves inside and outside of meetings.
- Explain Masonic Etiquette both in the Lodge/Chapter and at the Festive Board.
- Explain the need to learn Ritual and suggest methods that they might use to learn.
- Encourage them to learn a short piece of Ritual to get them used to speaking in Lodge/Chapter.
- Highlight the values of Freemasonry, such as brotherly love, relief, and truth.

5. FOSTER MASONIC CONNECTIONS

- Encourage your Lodge/Chapter to host informal gatherings or social events where new members can interact with brothers in a relaxed setting.
- Introduce the new member to members with similar interests or professions to establish common ground.
- Encourage the new member to participate in committees or projects that align with their strengths or interests.
- Invite the new member as your guest to MetGL/MetGC events and the meetings of other Lodges/Chapters.

6. ENGAGE THEM IN LEARNING

- Without flooding the new member with information, provide them with the resources, articles, or lectures that will deepen their understanding of Freemasonry, its history, philosophy, and symbolism. **Solomon** should be the first port of call.
- Offer the new member all the help they need to prepare for advancement through the degrees and beyond

- Ensure that the new member is Included in any discussions concerning Masonic teachings and encourage them to ask questions so that they can clarify things in their own mind.

7. ENCOURAGE INVOLVEMENT

- Encourage the new member to take on small but meaningful tasks or ritual during the Lodge/Chapter meetings to help them feel included.
- Encourage attendance at MetGL/MetGC and meetings of other Lodges/Chapters to expand their Masonic experience.
- If a new brother, suggest they join either the Connaught or Kent Clubs, as appropriate, to broaden their Masonic network.

8. RECOGNISE THEIR PROGRESS

- Celebrate milestones, such as advancing to higher degrees or completing Masonic education programs on Solomon.
- Publicly acknowledge their efforts and contributions during lodge/chapter meetings.
- Reinforce their value to the brotherhood through personal encouragement and praise.

9. MAINTAIN REGULAR CONTACT

- Casually enquire how they are adjusting to being a mason/companion and address any questions or concerns in a positive and timely manner.
- If they are feeling overwhelmed or disconnected, especially in the early stages, ensure that you take action to address the issue and get positive confirmation from the new member that they feel better about the situation.

10. DEMONSTRATE THE VALUE OF THE BROTHERHOOD

- Share personal stories of how Freemasonry has impacted your life to inspire the new member.
- Emphasize the importance of mutual support and being there for one another.

11. LEAD BY EXAMPLE

- When interacting with the new member be a model of the values and principles of Freemasonry.
- Always be patient and approachable, so that the new member will feel at ease asking questions or highlighting issues.
- Always be willing to guiding them on their Masonic journey and ensure that it is the journey they wish to take.

- You should always demonstrate to them what it means to be a committed and active Mason/Companion.
- Ensure that if they raise any questions you can't answer you either find the information or direct them to someone who can assist.

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Metropolitan Grand Mentor